

TriCore Regional Health

Prior Authorization Request Form — Outpatient Surgical Services

Requesting Provider Information

Provider Name:	Dr. Felix Okonkwo, MD
Practice:	Sonoran Surgical Group
NPI:	1558820047
Tax ID:	84-7729103
Contact Phone:	(602) 555-0221
Fax:	(602) 555-0222

Patient Information

Patient Name:	Angela M. Brooks
Patient ID:	PT-410872
Date of Birth:	01/30/1982
Member ID:	TC-50117-B
Group Number:	GRP-33810

Requested Service

CPT Code:	47562 — Laparoscopic cholecystectomy
ICD-10 Code:	K80.20 — Calculus of gallbladder without obstruction
Place of Service:	Outpatient Surgical Center
Requested Date:	2026-06-18
Units:	1
Est. Charge Amount:	\$22,400.00

Clinical Justification

Patient presents with recurrent right upper quadrant pain confirmed by ultrasound to be secondary to symptomatic cholelithiasis. Conservative dietary management has not resolved symptoms over the past 8 weeks. Surgical removal is recommended.

Submitted By:	Sonoran Surgical Group — Authorizations Dept.
Submission Date:	2026-06-18
Reference #:	PA-2026-711560

TriCore Regional Health

Utilization Management Department
900 N. Central Ave, Suite 220, Phoenix, AZ 85004

Date: 2026-06-10
Angela M. Brooks
PT-410872
Member ID: TC-50117-B

RE: Notice of Adverse Benefit Determination

Reference #:	PA-2026-711560
Claim #:	TC-CLM-50117
Amount Billed:	\$24,150.00
Service:	CPT 47562 — Laparoscopic Cholecystectomy
Requested Date:	2026-06-18
Determination:	DENIED
Denial Reason Code:	MN-11 — Medical necessity not established
Rendering Provider NPI:	1558820074

Explanation

Dear Ms. Brooks,

After review by our Medical Director, the requested procedure (CPT 47562) has been denied. The submitted documentation does not demonstrate a trial of conservative management consistent with TriCore Regional Health's Gallbladder Surgery Guideline GB-009, which requires a minimum 12-week documented dietary modification period prior to surgical intervention for non-obstructive cholelithiasis.

Appeal Rights

You or your provider have the right to request a formal appeal of this decision. Appeals must be received in writing at the address above, Attn: Appeals & Grievances, within **15 days** of this notice, and should include any additional supporting clinical documentation.

Sincerely,
Dr. Wendell Marsh, MD
Medical Director, TriCore Regional Health

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